



LEARNING PORTFOLIO

Disclaimer: This document was independently compiled by the author as a personal learning portfolio, based on knowledge gained while supporting a senior buyer in the laboratory procurement function. All names, codes, and figures presented are illustrative or anonymized for learning purposes only. This content does not originate from, and should not be interpreted as, any official business presentation, internal report, or confidential material of the pharmaceutical company where the author worked.

Executive Summary

Vietnam's fast-changing Chemical Law disrupted a pharma company's testing chemical supply, requiring both reactive fixes and proactive safeguards.

Situation

In Vietnam, chemicals are typically sourced through local traders rather than imported directly. Moreover, the chemical control list and related compliance data must be reviewed and updated annually

Complication

1 2025 Law on Chemicals and its implementing decrees and circulars became effective immediately upon issuance, giving businesses limited time to prepare.

2 Lack of implementation clarity and a complex multi-agency permit approval process have significantly extended import permit lead times.



Chemical imports are delayed, resulting in pending orders and supply uncertainty.

Question

“How can we ensure the continuous availability of testing chemicals for raw materials to prevent production disruption?”

Answer

Reactive

- Check for alternative products
- Outsource selected testing methods

Proactive

- Buffer higher safety stock level for critical chemicals
- Vendor & sourcing diversification

Problem statement – Category overview

Any disruption in chemical supply may result in production interruptions.

Chemicals in pharmaceutical production

Raw materials must be tested before production to verify quality against pharmacopoeia standards, ensure GMP compliance, detect contamination risks, and confirm compliance with the registered drug dossier, preventing costly recalls and protecting patient safety.

Current procurement practice of chemical in Company S

Chemicals are procured via traders, rather than imported directly from manufacturers, because of 2 following reasons:

1 Avoiding of unnecessary regulatory and administrative complexity

Direct importation of chemicals requires an eligibility certificate, chemical declaration, dedicated regulatory staff, and continuous monitoring of frequently changing requirements.

▶ Company S avoid compliance costs and risk of direct procurement from manufacturers.

2 Achieving MOQ and working capital efficiency

Chemical manufacturers generally sell in bulk lots or full containers. Traders aggregate demand across multiple buyers and redistribute in smaller quantities

▶ Company S procure only what is required for material testing, avoiding over-stock

▶ **Chemicals used for material testing are critical to production operations. Any disruption in chemical supply may result in production interruptions.**

Problem statement – Industry analysis

Poorly sequenced rollout of Vietnam's new Chemical Law left importers without clear guidance, resulting in chemical shipments strained at port for weeks.

01.06.2026

The situation does not change much. Many containers remains held at ports due to the **internal administrative process from the authorities’ agencies leads to difficulties in obtaining permits.**
(Source: Nụ Bùi, 2026)

17.01.2026

Decrees No. 24, 25, and 26/2026/ND-CP and Circulars No. 01 and 02/2026/TT-BCT were issued on 17 January 2026 to provide detailed implementation guidance for the 2025 Law on Chemicals (Law No. 69/2025/QH15).
(Source: Nguyệt Hà, 2026; Ngọc An, 2026)

01.01.2026

The 69/2025/QH15 Law on Chemicals came into effect. During the transition period, delays in implementing guidelines and new administrative procedures disrupted chemical import clearance, causing **many imported chemical raw material containers to be held at ports.**
(Source: Nguyệt Hà, 2026; Ngọc An, 2026)

14.06.2025

The 69/2025/QH15 Law on Chemicals, replacing the 2007 version, was passed by the National Assembly. It introduces **numerous new regulations on chemical safety and security, as well as conditions governing the export/import, of chemicals.**
(Source: Nguyệt Hà, 2026; Ngọc An, 2026)

Vietnam's Chemical Law took effect before its implementing decrees and circulars were ready, leaving a regulatory vacuum that stalled customs clearance and left chemical containers stranded at port for months.

Reference:

1.Ngọc An (2026) Loạt container hóa chất... mắc kẹt vì luật có hiệu lực nhưng thiếu văn bản hướng dẫn. Tuổi Trẻ Online, 14 January. Available at: <https://tuoitre.vn/loat-container-hoa-chat-mac-ket-vi-luat-co-hieu-luc-nhung-thieu-van-ban-huong-dan-20260114123803079.htm> (Accessed: 3 September 2026).

2.Nguyệt Hà (2026) Tháo gỡ "điểm nghẽn" thông quan cho doanh nghiệp hóa chất. VnEconomy, 18 January. Available at: <https://vneconomy.vn/thao-go-diem-nghe-nh-thong-quan-cho-doanh-nghiep-hoa-chat.htm> (Accessed: 3 September 2026).

3.Nụ Bùi (2026) Bộ Tài chính kiến nghị cởi trói thủ tục nhập khẩu hóa chất. Tạp chí Kinh tế - Tài chính (Thuế & Hải quan Online), 10 June. Available at: <https://thuehaiquan.tapchikinhthetataichinh.vn/bo-tai-chinh-kien-nghi-coi-troi-thu-tuc-nhap-khau-hoa-chat-158555.html> (Accessed: 3 September 2026).

Problem statement – Supplier analysis

V06 and V17's severe delivery delays stem from Vietnam's new Chemical Law licensing bottleneck, causing high production disruption due to their wide portfolio of items.

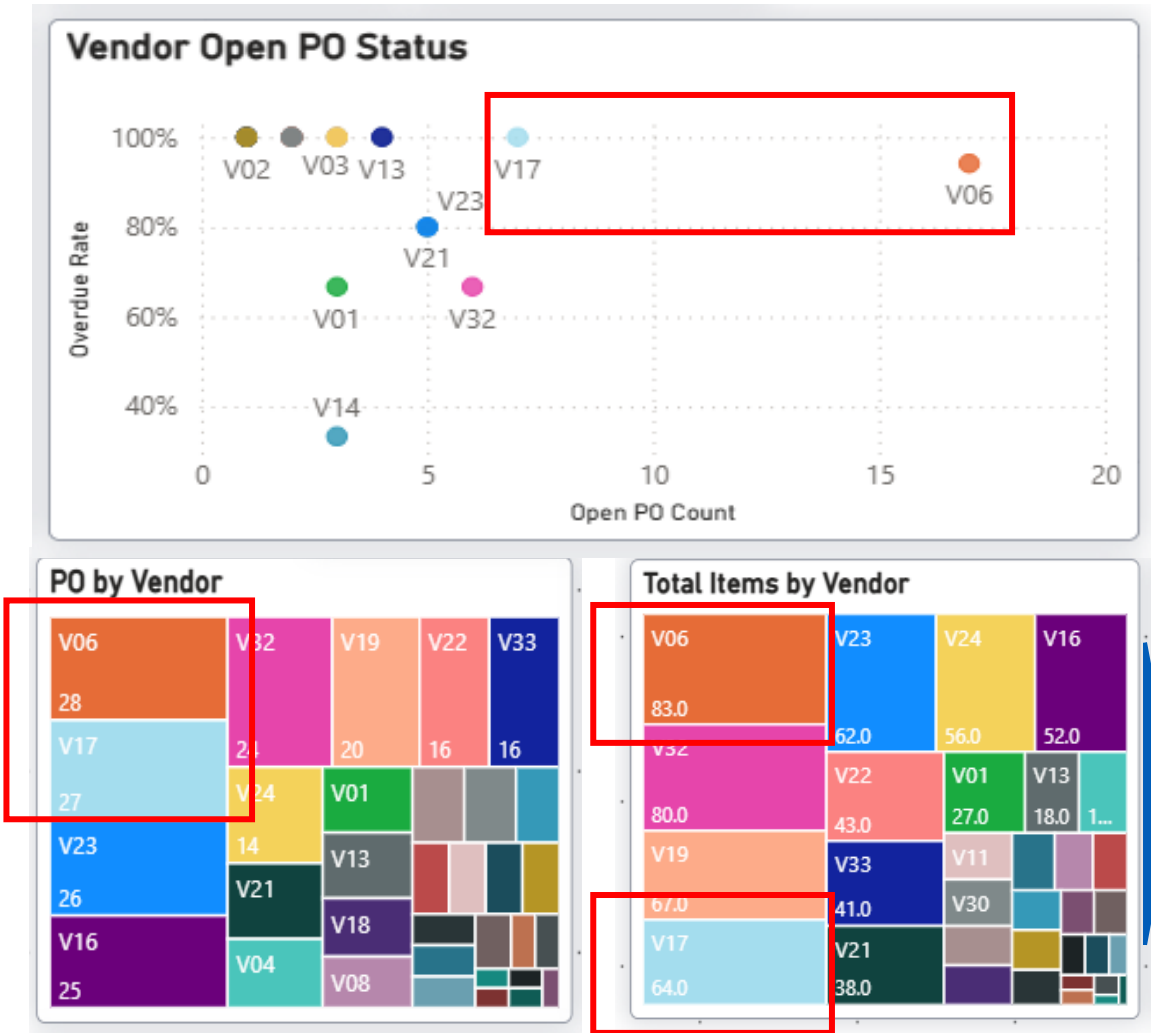


Figure: Supplier performance – Laboratory Category – Procurement Dashboard
(Source: Internal data, 2026)

March 03rd, 2026

Subject: Customer Notification on Import License Delays

Dear Valued Customers,

We are writing to inform you about the recent changes in the new chemical law that are impacting our ability to import certain chemicals. All import license requests for special-controlled chemicals are currently under review with the Ministry of Industry and Trade (MOIT), the Department of Industry and Trade (DOIT), and Peoples' Committee of Ho Chi Minh City for further approval. The internal administrative process from the authorities' agencies leads to difficulties in obtaining permits.

We would like to assure you that [redacted] is working diligently with both agencies to expedite the approval of our licenses. However, due to several objective reasons, including the fact that the Chemical Law 2025 takes effect from January 1, 2026, without specific guidance yet issued, goods cannot be cleared until specific guidance is provided. Notably, on January 17, 2026, when the decrees and guiding circulars are issued, they will take effect immediately. Although [redacted] has made efforts to complete the necessary procedures for submitting applications and closely monitor the relevant authorities, the process of obtaining this license has encountered unexpected delays, especially due to the extended Tet holiday.

Figure: Notification on Import license delays from Vendors
(Source: Vendor's public letter, 2026)

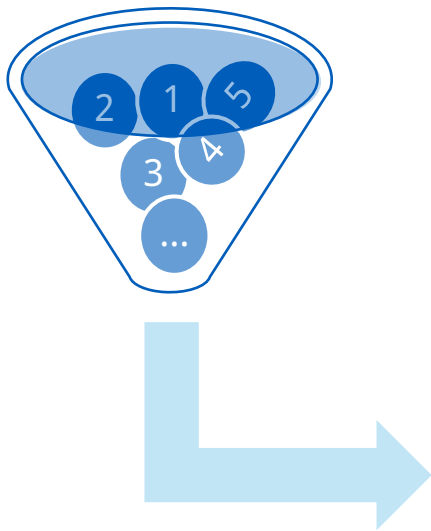
V06 and V17 are both suppliers of imported chemicals that fall under the highly controlled chemical categories regulated by the new law.

- V06 remains the most critical supplier with the most overdue POs (~92% across ~17 open POs). This leads to a high operational impact due to the scale of business involved.
- V17 records a 100% overdue rate (~7 open POs).

Solution analysis

Four solutions, balancing reactive fixes and proactive safeguards, are prioritized to address the chemical supply disruption within 6 months.

Considering current chemical law, feasibility and time-length, 4 solutions are selected to cope with the disruption of chemical supply.



		2026						Applied for
		Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	
1	Check for alternative products	Send RFQ and request CoA for cross-brand equivalents	QC team review & approve/reject equivalent product	Update approved vendor/product list				Reactive All chemicals
2	Outsource selected testing methods	Search for external labs and review lab qualification	Send specifications and test methods to an external lab to confirm testing capability.	Confirm service agreement, send samples, and receive test report				Reactive Chemicals with no alternative source available
3	Buffer higher safety stock level for critical chemicals		Review all chemicals in use to identify those need conditional business or special control.	Check annual production plan to calculate stock level	Check shelf-life and storage constraints before increasing stock	Place orders for annual demand		Proactive All chemicals, especially those need conditional business or special control
4	Vendor & sourcing diversification		Build vendor and chemical database covering lead time, MOQ, shelf-life, storage condition, and regulatory status	Identify single-source, high-risk items and shortlist alternative vendors	Qualify new vendors and rebalance order allocation across approved sources			Proactive All chemicals, especially those need conditional business or special control

Lessons learn by the author

An 8-month journey gives the author the opportunity to learn about how a pharmaceutical company works under a highly regulated environment, and how to use technical tools and analytical skills to identify the risk.

Domain knowledge

- **Vietnam's chemical regulatory framework:** First hands-on exposure to studying a specific law in depth, gaining an understanding of how regulatory changes translate into real operational impact on business activities
- **Role of traders in the chemical supply chain:** Understood why manufacturing companies typically procure through traders rather than importing directly (due to regulatory barriers, MOQ constraints, hazardous storage infrastructure).
- **Role of incoming raw material testing in GMP:** Understood why raw material QC testing is a mandatory step, and its link to CoA, drug registration dossiers, and batch-to-batch variation risk.
- **Criteria for evaluating alternative products:** Understood the role of CoA in confirming technical equivalence before switching suppliers.
- **Sample submission process for external testing labs:** Learned the documentation required (test request form, CoA, MSDS, chain of custody)

Analytical skills

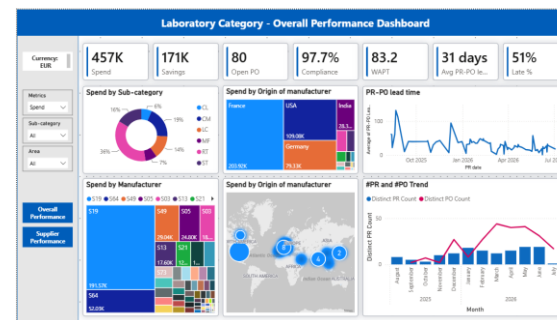
Metric selection for forward-looking risk assessment: Learned to choose and combine metrics that help stakeholders assess future supply risk from historical vendor data, rather than simply reporting past performance

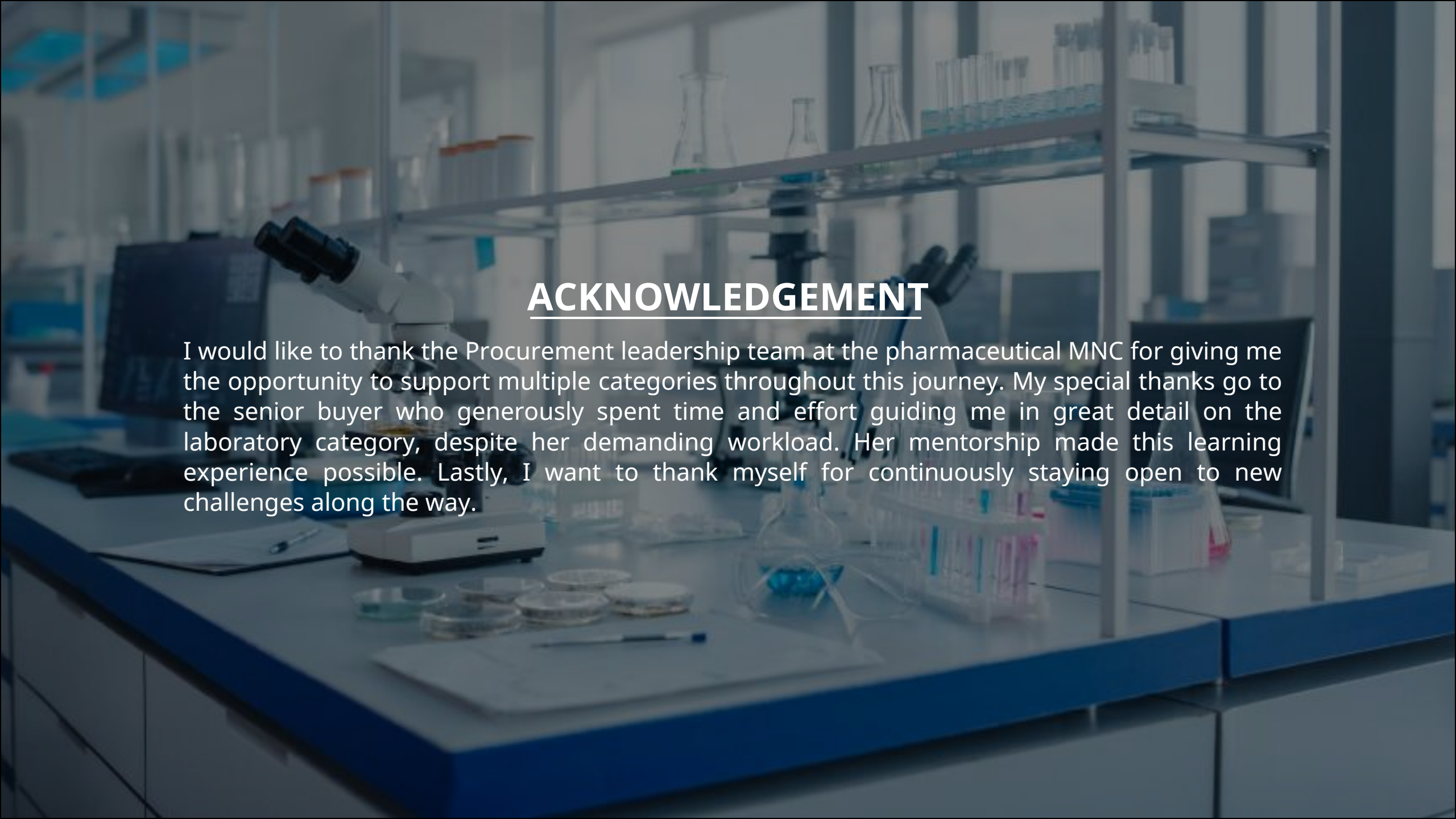
Technical Tools

Power BI: Built and interpreted dashboards to visualize vendor performance, enabling data-driven root cause analysis. (Link to the dashboard: [GitHub](#))

Power Query: Learned a way to reduce processing time for raw data containing multiple errors, while keeping the correction process traceable

AI (for prompting): Used AI to assist with drafting DAX measures, selecting appropriate KPI metrics, and structuring the proposal





ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I would like to thank the Procurement leadership team at the pharmaceutical MNC for giving me the opportunity to support multiple categories throughout this journey. My special thanks go to the senior buyer who generously spent time and effort guiding me in great detail on the laboratory category, despite her demanding workload. Her mentorship made this learning experience possible. Lastly, I want to thank myself for continuously staying open to new challenges along the way.